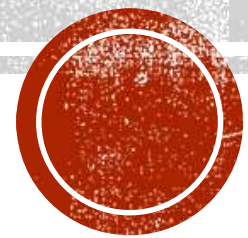
ENG 1011, ENGLISH 1

FUTURE TENSE

Forms, Types, Functions, Pragmatic Usage, and Practice



SAJJAD HOSSAIN

Department of English, UIU

CLASSIFICATIONS AND STRUCTURES

1. **Future Simple:** Subject+will+V1/ Subject+be going to+V1
   - Example: "I will call you." / "I am going to study.“

2. **Future Continuous:** Subject+will be+V-ing
   - Example: "I will be studying at 10 PM.“

3. **Future Perfect:** Subject+will have+V3
   - Example: "I will have finished the assignment by 5 PM.“

4. **Future Perfect Continuous**: Subject+will have been+V-ing
   - Example: "By 5 PM, I will have been reading for three hours."



FUTURE SIMPLE — TIME MARKERS & SPONTANEOUS DECISIONS

- Rule 1: Time Indicators for Future Simple:
- Trigger Words: Tomorrow, Next (day/week/month/year)
- "He will call you tomorrow.“
- "My brother will clean his room next Saturday.“
- Rule 2: Spontaneous Decisions & Discourse Functions (Will)
- Instant Decision: Decided at the moment of speaking ("I'm tired. I think I'll go to sleep.")
- Do not use Present Simple for instant decisions:

✗ Incorrect: "I go and shut the door.“

✓ Correct: "I'll go and shut the door.“

- Offers & Promises: "That bag looks heavy. I will help you with it." / “Thanks for the money. I will pay you back soon.“
- Refusals (Won't = Will Not): Expresses refusal by people or inanimate objects:

✓ "I've tried to give her advice, but she won't listen.“

✓ "The car won't start." (= The car 'refuses' to start)

- Requesting: "Will you please turn the music down? I'm trying to concentrate.“

INTENTIONS VS. INSTANT DECISIONS (WILL VS. BE GOING TO)

- Key Distinctions: The choice depends on when the decision was made.
- Instant Decision (Will): Decided now at the moment of speaking.
- Context: “Karim phoned while you were out.“
- Response: "OK. I'll call him back." (Spontaneous)

- Pre-planned Intention (Be Going To): Decided before the moment of speaking.
- Context: “Zara phoned while you were out.“
- Response: "Yes, I know. I'm going to call her back."

- (Pre-meditated) Fixed Arrangements (Present Continuous): Reserved for arranged social/travel plans.
- "I'm going on holiday next Saturday." (Not "I'll go")

FUTURE CONTINUOUS (WILL BE- VERB+ING)

- Action in Progress at a Specific Future Time:
- "Don't phone between 7 and 8 PM. We'll be having dinner.“
- "This time next week, I'll be lying on the beach.“

- Complete Scheduled / Expected Events:
- Similar in usage to be going to for planned agenda items.
- “The government will be making a statement about the crisis later today.“
- "Will you be going away this summer?"

FUTURE PERFECT (WILL HAVE + V3)

- Completed Action Before a Future Time/Deadline:
- Evaluates a future event as already finished from a specific future standpoint. "Sally leaves for work at 8:30 AM. At 9:00 AM, she won't be at home — she'll have gone to work.“
- "We're late. The film will already have started by the time we get to the cinema.“

- **Tense Contrast Matrix:**
- Present Perfect: "They have been married for 24 years.
- Future Perfect: "Next year, they will have been married for 25 years.“
- Past Perfect: "When their son was born, they had been married for 3 years."



TIME MARKERS FOR FUTURE PERFECT (BY + TIME)

- Trigger Phrases: By this time, By + specific time, By next month/year, By then
- Core Rule: Indicates an action that will be fully completed before a designated time in the future.

- **Examples:**
- "By this time next year, I will have completed my degree.“
- "By the end of this month, she will have read all the required chapters.“
- "By then, the technical team _____ (solve) the issue.“
- "By 2027, the firm _____ (open) a new regional branch."



THE DUAL CLAUSE STRUCTURE: "BY THE TIME“ GRAMMAR RULE:

- Main Clause (Future Form)+ **by the time** +Subordinate Clause (Present Simple)
- Select the Tense of the Main Clause Based on Meaning:
- Simple Future Event (just happens):
  - "He will call you by the time you return.“

- Prior Completion (happens BEFORE that time):
  - "By the time the class starts, the students will have finished their assignments.“
  - "She will have prepared the report by the time the manager asks for it.

- Ongoing Duration (continues UP TO that time):
  - "By the time the teacher arrives, the students will have been studying for two hours.“



FUTURE PERFECT CONTINUOUS (WILL HAVE BEEN+-ING)

- Function: Emphasizes the duration of an action continuing up to a specific future point or deadline.
- Key Visual Formula: Look for time markers like By... + for [duration].
- "By 5 o'clock, I will have been studying for six hours without a break.“
- "Next month, she will have been working at this firm for ten years.“

- Future Perfect vs. Future Perfect Continuous:
- Future Perfect (Result/Completion): "By 2027, I will have written three books.“
- Future Perfect Continuous (Duration/Process): "By 2027, I will have been writing books for five years."



CLAUSE CONNECTIONS WITH "BEFORE“:

- Structures with Before:
- Future Indefinite+ before +Present Indefinite
- Future Perfect+ before +Present Indefinite

- How to Decide the Meaning:
- Simple Future Action:

✓ "I will complete the assignment before the teacher checks it.“

✓ "He will make the payment before the store closes.“

- Completed Prior Action (Emphasizing Completion First):

✓ "They will have finished the project before the official deadline comes.“

✓ "We will have solved the problem before the lecturer explains it.“



CLAUSE CONNECTIONS WITH "AFTER":

- Structures with After
- Future Indefinite + after + Present Perfect (Most common for emphasizing completion)
- Future Indefinite + after + Present Indefinite (Common for routine or immediate sequence)
- How to Decide the Meaning
- 1. Completed Prior Action (Emphasizing Completion First):
- Use this structure when you want to highlight that the first action must be fully finished before the subsequent future action can start. The event following "after" uses the Present Perfect tense.
- Example: "I will submit the assignment after the teacher has checked it." *(The teacher finishes checking first, then I submit.)*
- 2. Sequential Future Action (Routine or Immediate Succession)
- Use this structure for general future sequences, routines, or actions that happen immediately one after the other. The event following "after" uses the Present Indefinite tense.
- Example: "They will launch the project after the official deadline comes."
- *(Note: Unlike "before", we rarely use the Future Perfect ["will have done"] before the word "after", because the action before "after" happens second, not first).*



SUBORDINATE CONJUNCTIONS (WHEN, AS SOON AS, UNTIL, IN CASE):

- The "No-Will" Rule in Subordinate Time & Condition Clauses:
- Formula: Main Clause (Future Simple)+ Conjunction+ Subordinate Clause (Present Simple)
- Grammatical Rule: Do NOT use will inside the subordinate clause.
- ✕ Incorrect: "I'll phone you when I will get home.“
- ✓ Correct: "I'll phone you when I get home.“

- Examples:
- Till / Until: "I will wait here till you finish your work.“
- As soon as: "As soon as the rain stops, we will go outside.“
- When: "They will inform us when the meeting begins.“
- Unless (Conditional): "Unless you study regularly, you will not pass.“
- In case (Precaution): "I will take an umbrella in case it rains."

CONDITIONALS AND MODAL USAGE (IF VS. WHEN)

- Future Conditionals (If + Present Simple):
- ✕ Incorrect: "We'll get wet if it will rain.“
- ✓ Correct: "We'll get wet if it rains.“

- Certainty (When) vs. Possibility (If):
- When (Certain): "I'm going out later. When I go out, I'll get some bread.“
- If (Possible): "I might go out later. If I go out, I'll get some bread."



PRAGMATIC SHIFT — THE MEANING OF "NOW“

- "Now" does not automatically mean Present Continuous. Check the Context!
- Context A: Action Happening Right Now (Present Continuous): Indicates an ongoing physical action in the present moment.

➢ "Look! The students are doing their homework now.“

➢ "My mother is cooking dinner now.“

- Context B: Decision, Promise, or Next Step (Future Simple)
- "Now" can signal an immediate transition to a new action/promise starting from this moment onward.

➢ "Now I will give you an example.“

➢ "Now he will tell us the answer."

INTERACTIVE PRACTICE — PART 1

- Directions: Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the verb in future tense.
- Sahil cannot go to the party. He ___ (work) all day tomorrow.
- They ___ (not/start) the presentation unless the multimedia works properly.
- Faraz believes that he ___ (make) millions of pounds from his pictures by forty.
- Alif: "You still have not put those books up, Tanim." Tanim: "Alright. I ___ (do) it now."
- By the time the speaker finishes her introduction, we ___ (sit) in this lecture hall for two hours.
- By next year, our company ___ (open) a new international branch.
- As soon as the director ___ (arrive), the seminar will begin.
- By the time you come back, I ___ (read) this entire book.
- Listen carefully! Now the instructor ___ (explain) the final rule.
- They ___ (play) football for two hours by the time the sun sets.

INTERACTIVE PRACTICE — PART 2 (ERROR CORRECTION & LOGIC)

- **Directions:** Identify the error or select the correct form based on sentence context.

- Correct the sentence: "We will start the exam when the bell will ring.

_____.

- Choose the correct option: "Look at that driver! He (will crash / is going to crash) into the fence!“

- Identify the meaning: "Now I will show you the next slide.“
- A) Present ongoing action B) Immediate future intention/next step

- Correct the sentence: "By the time he will arrive, I will leave.“

_____.

ANSWER KEY

- will be working (Action in progress at a specific future time)
- will not start / won't start (Conditional simple future)
- will have made (Action completed before a future age deadline)
- will do / 'll do (Spontaneous decision made at the moment of speaking)
- will have been sitting (Emphasis on duration continuing up to a future point)
- will have opened (Trigger: By next year → Future Perfect)
- arrives (Subordinate clause with "as soon as" uses Present Simple)
- will have read (Trigger: By the time... → Future Perfect)
- is explaining / will explain (Depends on context: "is explaining" for physical action happening now; "will explain" for a announced next step)
- will have been playing (Trigger: By the time... + duration "for two hours" → Future Perfect Continuous)
- **Part-2:**
- We will start the exam when the bell rings." (Remove will from time clause)
- is going to crash (Based on immediate visual evidence)
- B (Announcing the immediate next step/intention)
- "By the time he arrives, I will have left." (Present simple in "by the time" clause + Future Perfect in main clause)